

Branch eNewsletter

Introduction

The Hawaii State Public Library System uses the software PatronPoint to issue emails to library patrons and others who have signed up to receive updates. HSPLS has not sold or provided patron information for any outside marketing purposes. These emails are to provide only HSPLS information to our patrons.

There are various types of communication sent to patrons:

- Systemwide Monthly eNewsletter
- Updates on major library projects such as renovations
- Special interest newsletters such as Kids and Families, Tween and Teens, and Seniors
- Branch specific emails managed by library staff.

This document details the policies and procedures for branch specific emails managed by library staff.

This is a working document that may be updated at issues arise. Please check the revision date to ensure you are looking at the most up to date document.

Policy

Who can send eNewsletters?

Only authorized staff, who have received eNewsletter training, may edit and create enewsletters. Branch managers can designate staff to be authorized. The authorized staff will schedule a training session with Library Development Services Section staff before being granted sign-in privileges.

While in the initial training period (about three months), all branch enewsletters must be reviewed by Library Development Services Section staff to check for editorial standards and ADA compliance.

What can you send?

Branches are instructed to limit the number of emails sent to patrons. This is intended to keep staff from inundating patrons with emails and ultimately reduce the number of unsubscribes.

There are three categories of emails/newsletters branches may send:

- **Monthly Newsletter**

Purpose: Snapshot of what is happening in the library that month. A helpful guideline is that anything you would post on a library bulletin board may be included here.

- Sent mid-month to advertise for the upcoming month
- Avoid sending near the first of the month, as that is when the HSPLS Statewide newsletter is sent.
- May include sections for:
 - Message to patrons from staff
 - Program / Event to Highlight
 - Library Resource to Highlight
 - Library's involvement in community events
 - Staff Picks
 - Upcoming Holiday Hours

- **Special Event Highlight**

Purpose: Intended for large, special events such as kick-offs, anniversaries, or the launch of a new recurring event/service. This should serve as a reminder to patrons of the upcoming event, and not the announcement.

- Sent within a timeframe that will be reasonable for advertising the event. In general, at least one week is a good timeframe for this type of email.
- You may use the information that is posted on the online events calendar.

- **Branch Alert / Updates**

Purpose: Inform patrons of major changes to the library that may change the way they use our services. This may include planned temporary closures, emergency updates (i.e. water main breaks, road closures, natural disasters).

- All branch alerts and updates must be approved by the executive team.
- In the event of an emergency, the Library Development Services Section may send an alert on behalf of the branch staff.

What images can be used?

All images must be copyright free. Users may upload their own copyright-free image or use an existing image from the image library on Patron Point.

All images uploaded must include alternative text (alt text). A simple image description will suffice.

If a patron can be easily identified in a photo, a photography release form must be completed and signed by the patron. This does not include event photos of large crowds that had “event photography” notices posted. These forms must be maintained in your branch in the event a patron complains.

Procedure

Initial Training Period

During the **first three months** of using the enewsletter, all emails sent from the branches must be reviewed by Library Development Services Section staff for editorial standards. This includes ensuring the settings within the software are correct, checking for any potential ethics violations, and ensuring that the email meets ADA accessibility standards.

LDSS may need up to one week to review your draft depending on other projects and deadlines within the section.

After the Training Period

Once the initial training period is completed, you will no longer need to submit newsletters to the Library Development Services Section for review before sending. You will be informed when you no longer need to send newsletters for review.

Although LDSS will not be reviewing your emails, they need to be included in the send list.

Email Creation Process

Prep Text and Photos

Draft the content of your email / newsletter in a word document before you start creating it in Patron Point. This will save you time and make it easier to find typos.

Use the PowerPoint templates provided to resize your photos into the correct aspect ratio. Save the PowerPoint as a jpeg and upload the photos to the Patron Point media library ahead of time. This will save you time as you draft your email.

Images Sizes

You will need to resize all photos to make sure they are small enough to send via email.

Patron Point newsletters have layouts in single, double, and triple columns. You should size your images to work with the layout you are using. The height can vary, but the width should follow these guidelines:

Single Column

1200 pixels wide

Double Column

600 pixels wide	600 pixels wide
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Triple Column

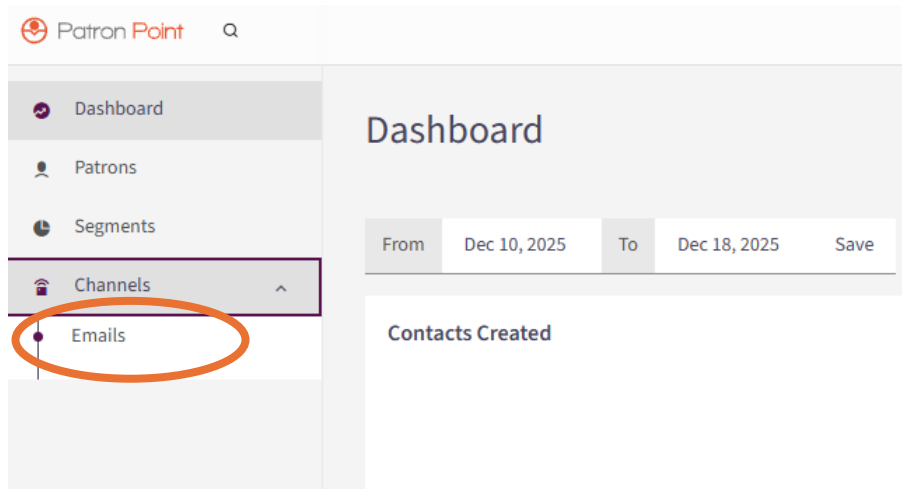
400 pixels wide	400 pixels wide	400 pixels wide
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Create an email in Patron Point

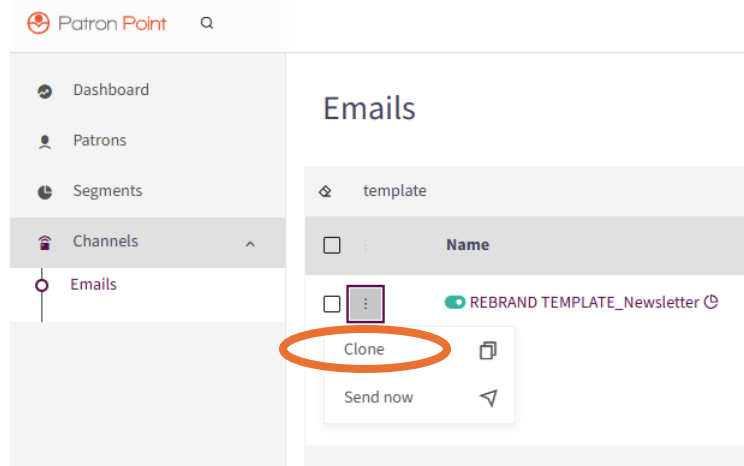
Sign into Patron Point: [HSPLS.patronpoint.com/s/dashboard](https://hspls.patronpoint.com/s/dashboard)

To create a new email:

1. From the Patron Point dashboard, click on **Channels**, and select **Emails** from the sub-menu.



2. Select and **clone the template**
 - a. REBRAND TEMPLATE_Newsletter



3. On the **What type of email do you want to create** modal, click the **Select** button for the email type to create. Branches will always use “New Segment Email”
 - a. **New Segment Email:** These are emails that will be manually sent out to selected patron segment(s).

What type of email do you want to create? ×

Campaign email 

- ✓ For campaigns, forms and points events
- ✓ Allows to send multiple times
- ✓ Suited for transactional use
- ✓ Based on users' specific actions

Select

Segment email 

- ✓ For newsletters, offers, updates etc
- ✓ Allows one send per patron
- ✓ Designed for marketing use
- ✓ Used in mass email sending

Select

4. After selecting the email type, you'll be redirected to the email's editing page. From here, the CUSTOMER THEME will always be your default.

5. To the right of the theme information, fill out the settings and parameters for the email. Please note that you can change these details at any time until the email is sent.

The screenshot shows the 'Builder' interface for creating an email. At the top, there is a navigation bar with 'Builder' and three buttons: 'Save' (with a checkmark), 'Save & Close' (with a document icon), and 'Cancel' (with an 'x' icon). Below this, the settings are organized into several sections:

- Subject ***: A text input field containing 'REBRAND TEMPLATE_Newsletter 10' and a red 'x' icon for clearing the text.
- Suggest Subject with AI**: A purple button.
- Internal Name ***: A text input field containing 'REBRAND TEMPLATE_Newsletter'.
- Preheader Text ⓘ**: A large, empty text area.
- Patron segment ***: A dropdown menu with the text 'Choose one or more...'.
- Exclude patron segment**: A dropdown menu with the text 'Choose one or more...'.
- Category**: A dropdown menu showing 'Pilot Program (11)'.
- Language ***: A dropdown menu showing 'English'.
- Is a translation of ⓘ**: A dropdown menu with the text 'Choose a translated item...'.
- Available for use**: A toggle switch currently set to 'No'.
- Unsubscribe feedback form ⓘ**: A dropdown menu with the text 'Choose one...'.

- Subject:** What people who receive your email will see in their inbox.
- Internal Name:** How we sort the emails in Patron Point. Please use the following format:
YEAR_MM_Branch_Type of Email
- Preheader Text:** A short summary of the email that will display in some inboxes. This is an optional element
- Patron Segment:** Who your email will be sent to. While creating the email use "Placeholder". To send add your patron segment and "HSPLS Review and Test".
- Category:** Pilot Program
- Available for Use:** While writing toggle this to "No". When you're ready to send the email, toggle to "Yes". The email will not send if it has not be marked as available.

6. Every Patron Point system has an assigned default sender, but it is possible to change this information on an individual email using the **Advanced tab**. Here you can customize the email sender's name, address, and reply to address. If these fields are left empty, the default configuration will be used.

- Change "From name"** to your branch's full name
 - e.g.: Waimea Public Library; Waimanalo Public and School Library

- b. If you want patrons to be able to respond to your email **change the “From address” and “Reply to address”** to your libraries email. If you don’t want to manage responses, leave these blank.

New Email

Theme Advanced

From name ⓘ

From address ⓘ

Reply to address ⓘ

Use patron owner as mailer ⓘ

☐ No

7. Hit the **Save & Close** or **Save** button to save your progress and create the email.

Builder Save Save & Close Cancel

Subject *

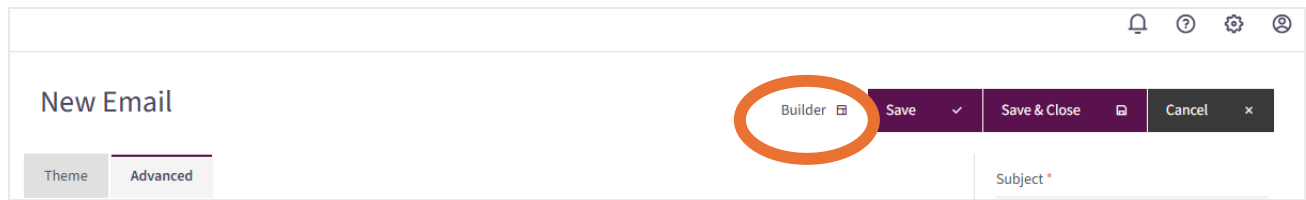
Using the Email Builder

After creating and saving your email, you can use the Builder to build out the content of the email you'll be sending to your patrons.

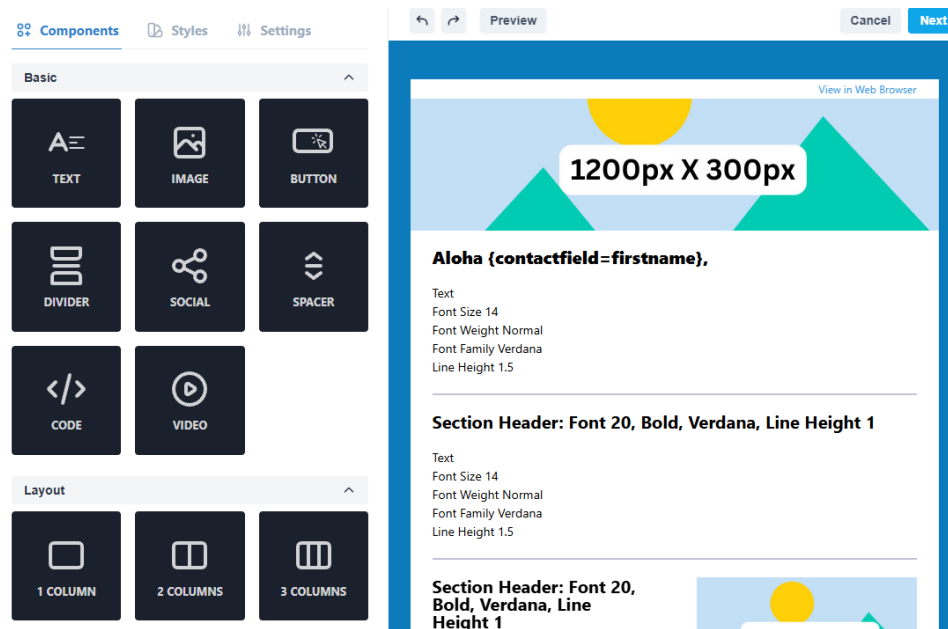
Save your progress!

Patron Point does **not** have an autosave function. You *must* save your work manually as you progress through the building process. Close out of the builder and click **Save** to save your progress. If you would like to take a break from working and come back later, hit **Save & Close** instead.

To edit the email, click on the **Builder** button



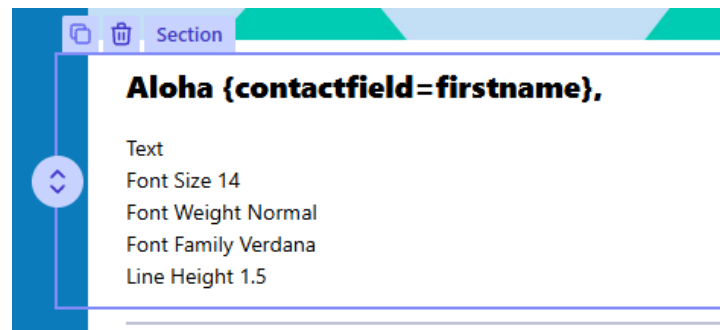
Once you are in the Builder, you will see the **Components** on the Left and the email you are writing on the right. The components have two sections: **basic** and **layout**.



Layout / Sections

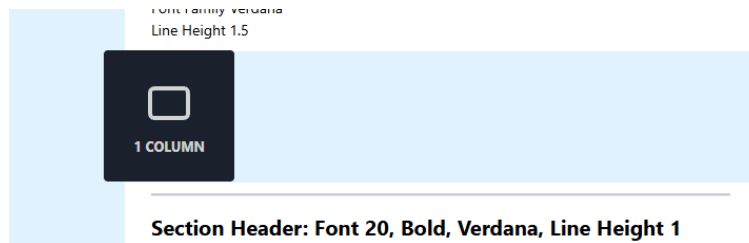
The columns that create different sections of the email.

1. Cloning and Moving Layout/Sections within the email template.



1. Hover on the left to see the purple outline of the section.
2. Left click to see the options for cloning and deleting the section.
3. Click on the up and down arrows to grab and section and then drag it where you want to place it.

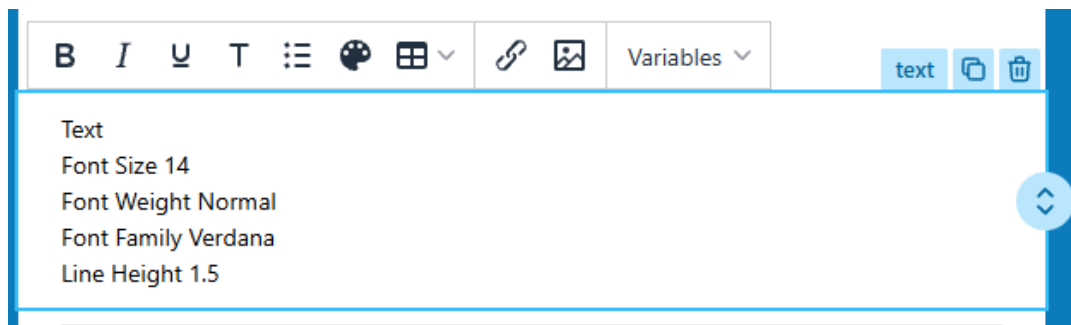
2. Add a new section from components.
 1. Hover over the layout you want until you see a hand icon.
 2. Left click to grab the layout and then drop it where you want it on the email.



Basic / Elements

Cloning and Moving Elements within the email template.

1. Hover on the right to see the blue outline of the element.
2. Left click to see the options for cloning and deleting the section.
3. Click on the up and down arrows to grab and section and then drag it where you want to place it.



Copying and Pasting Text

If you have written the text of your newsletter in a word document, you can copy and paste the text into the email by Copy and paste text by **using keyboard shortcuts** for Copy (CTRL + C) and paste (CTRL + V). **You cannot right-click to paste into the email.**

Add an element from components

The recommended basic elements are Text, Image, Button, Divider, and Spacer. The other elements are not recommended for a branch newsletter.

1. Hover over the layout you want until you see a hand icon.
2. Left click to grab the layout and then drop it where you want it on the email.
3. If you are adding from the components instead of cloning from the email, you will need to adjust the style settings of each element to match the email.

Element Style Settings

Font

Section Heading	Subheading	Paragraph Text	Caption
Font Size 20 Font Weight Bold Font Family Verdana Line Height 1	Font Size 16 Font Weight Normal Font Family Verdana Line Height 1.5	Font Size 14 Font Weight Normal Font Family Verdana Line Height 1.5	Font Size 12 Font Weight Normal Font Family Verdana Line Height 1

Button

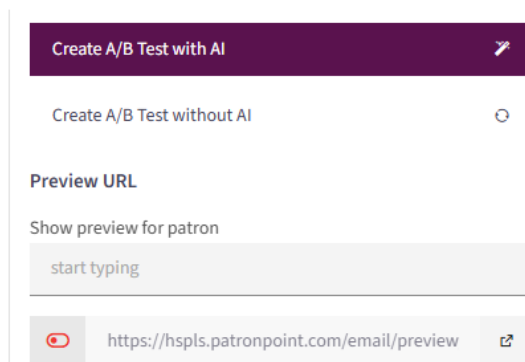
- Font Size 14
- Font Weight Bold
- Font Family Verdana
- Border Radius 10px

Divider

- Color Hex bfc3d3
- Solid
- 2 px

Save and Preview

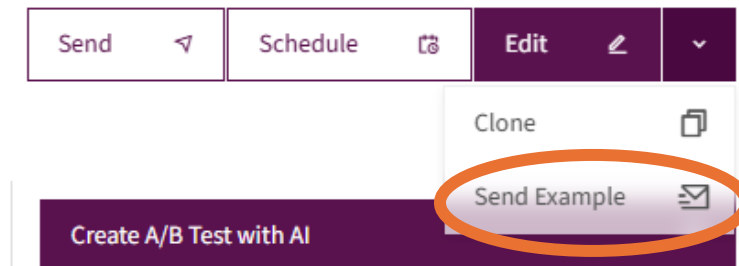
1. Once an email is ready for testing, click **Next** and then **Save & Close**. This will take you to the email home screen.
2. To preview how the email will look in a browser window, select the **preview button** next to the email URL.



Sending a Test Email

If you are in the initial training period, you will need to send an example to LDSS.

From the email home screen, click on the small down arrow next to “Edit” and select “Send Example”



In the popup box add the address **lds@librarieshawaii.org**. This will send an email to the LDSS staff to review your newsletter. Be sure to click on “**Send**”.

A screenshot of a 'Send Example' popup form. The form has a title 'Send Example' and a close button (X). Below the title, there is a section labeled 'Recipients' with a red asterisk. Under 'Recipients', there is a button 'Add recipient' and a list of recipients. One recipient is listed: 'lds@librarieshawaii.org'. Below the recipients section, there is a section labeled 'Contact' with a text input field containing the placeholder 'start typing'. At the bottom of the form, there are two buttons: 'Send' and 'Cancel'.

LDSS staff will review the newsletter and let you know if there are any changes needed.

After making revisions, change the status to “**Available for Use**”, and change the patron segment to your branch’s **patron segment** and **HSPLS review and Test**. You are now able to schedule your email to be sent.

Schedule the Email to be Sent

1. Find your email and click on the edit button to add the sending information.
 1. Check your internal name and subject
 2. Change the patron segment to **your branch’s patron segment** and **HSPLS Review and Test**

3. Change the status to “**Available for Use**”.

4. Click on “**Save & Close**”

Edit Email - DELETE REBRAND
TEMPLATE_Newsletter

Theme Advanced

Builder

Save

Save & Close

Cancel

Subject *

3. On the next page click on **Schedule**.

← Back to Emails

DELETE REBRAND
TEMPLATE_Newsletter

Available for use

Segment email

Send

Schedule

Edit

4. A dialog box opens. Set your send **date and time** to begin the send.

If the toggle is set to **No**, then the email will only be sent once to the chosen segment(s). If the toggle is set to **Yes**, the email will continue to go out to any new Patrons who enter the selected segment(s) until the End Sending date and time have been reached.

Schedule sending

Start sending date and time

Let the AI choose the best time during the next 24 hours

No

When enabled, our system analyzes each patron's engagement patterns to send your email at their most active times, boosting visibility and overall results.

Continue sending to patrons added to the segment after sending has started?

No

Schedule

Cancel

- a. In the **End sending** field, enter the date and time you would like the email to stop sending to the selected segment(s).

Important!

If no date is specified, the email will continue to be sent to new patrons until it is unpublished.

- b. Once you've set your parameters, click on **Schedule**. The e-mail is now scheduled. Once the send date has been reached, a pictogram appears next to the name of the email indicating that the email is **being sent**.

FAQs

1. When should the emails be sent?

- a. Aim to send your branch's emails on or around the 15th of the month to advertise for the following month. For example, emails sent on January 15th would include information for the month of February.

2. Can we include information on upcoming community events?

- a. Yes. The newsletter can be used to inform the community about upcoming events that align with the library's mission and/or that the library will be participating in. For example:
 - i. A library partner will be hosting a free event for the public. The library does not need to be involved but the event should be free, public, and in alignment with the HSPLS's mission.
 - ii. The library will be participating in outreach at a local event; invite your patrons to visit your booth to say hello.

3. Can we promote our branch's Friends of the Library affiliate group?

- a. The newsletter is an official form of communication from the State of Hawaii and as such, we want to comply with state ethics. The following are guidelines regarding promoting FLH using your branch's newsletter:
 - i. Acknowledgement of Support: Yes, please acknowledge support from the Friends of the Library of Hawaii and their affiliates.
 - ii. All other types of collaboration on content (book sales, membership drives, etc.) should be approved by the Office of the State Librarian (OSL).

4. Our branch has a list of contacts we want to send emails to. Can they be added into Patron Point?

- a. If you have a list of contact you want added to your branch's email segment, please provide a csv file with the name and email address for each contact. LDSS will contact Patron Point support to have these emails added on your behalf.

5. What are the types of images we should be using the eNewsletter?

- a. Try to use photos as much as possible. If the photos have people, that's even better.
- b. Ensure that all images are copyright free and include alt text.
- c. JPG format is preferred
- d. Photos should be resized to be easily emailed. The maximum size is 1,200 pixels. A guide to image sizes is:
 - i. One Column – Maximum width 1,200 px

- ii. Two Column – Maximum width 600 px
- iii. Three Column – Maximum width 400 px

6. How do patrons sign up for more than one email list?

- a. We realize that patrons may visit more than one branch, but at the moment we do not have way of having them sign up to receive emails from more than one branch. We plan to add this functionality in the future.

Who to Contact

Contact the Library Development Services Section if you have any questions.